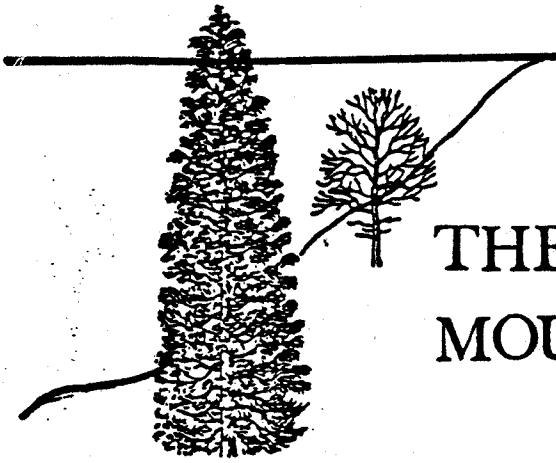


THE MOUNTAINSIDE NEWS

MOUNTAINSIDE POTPOURRI February 1991

Fire Safety for All Homeowners

A smallish (about a dozen) interested group of homeowners attended the 29 December fire safety lecture/demonstration, preceded by a holiday wassail open house at the mountainside home of Bob and Sarah Hay. The Berkeley Springs Fire Chief and two assistants provided the following important fire safety information for ALL homeowners:

1. Optimally, every house should have a smoke detector in each room. Battery-powered detectors are preferred over electric since power can be interrupted during a fire.

2. Every home should have one or more fire extinguishers stored in an easily accessible place. A fire extinguisher in the kitchen in just good common sense! Extinguishers should be rated for A (combustible fires); B (flammable liquids); and C (electrical equipment).

3. Wood stoves and fireplace flues should be periodically cleaned. If used regularly (i.e., every week), flues should be inspected once a year and cleaned as required. The Fire Department can provide names of competent local chimney sweeps.

4. The Fire Department distributes special decals that can be attached to specific windows, indicating where children may be sleeping in the house. They also have a variety of pamphlets pertaining to fire safety in the home, and members are encouraged to stop in at the fire house, request the decals and pamphlets, and talk with the personnel about special concerns.

While We're Talking About Fire...

The Association is pursuing the installion of a dry fire hydrant at the intersection of Herbert Quick Drive and Cold Run Valley Road. The hydrant will permit tank trucks to refill quickly from Lake Siri, avoiding the loss of valuable time by going back to a hydrant in Berkeley Springs. Once the hydrant is installed, we suggest you advise your insurance agent.

Let It Snow, Let It Snow, Let It Snow

Following is a quick guide for homeowners who want to deal rationally and effectively with the snow.

1. If the homeowner regularly rents his/her home through Coolfont, the driveway will be cleared by Coolfont. If this isn't happening, call the Lodge.

2. If the homeowner has special arrangements with Coolfont (e.g., conference renting only), the driveway will be cleared ONLY IF the house is being used by Coolfont at the time of the snow storm.

3. Other homeowners who want their driveways cleared can contact Alice Minnamon (258-5352 on the Mountainside) to make arrangements.

[The editor sincerely regrets that this information was not publicized prior to the snowy weekends in December.]

Association Documents Available

The Association has completed its review and update of all of its pertinent operating documents. Members who want to obtain any of these documents should contact Sarah Hay (7930 Brink Rd., Gaithersburg, MD 20882; 301/926-7007) after March 10. The documents include:

CMA Bylaws
Declaration of Covenants and Restrictions
DACC Guidelines for Building at Coolfont
Regulations Regarding the Use of Property
1986 CDC/CMA Memorandum of Agreement
Current year's budget

Signs of the Times

On the advice and recommendation of the Berkeley Springs Fire Chief, CMA will install uniform home identification signs as well as other location identification signs that will help fire trucks and other emergency vehicles who need to quickly identify a house requiring assistance. Individual homes will be labeled by lot section and number (e.g., F-4). Other signs will identify the sections (A, B, C, etc.) or section groups.

The Association welcomes the following new members:

Tim N. Black of Washington, D.C., who has purchased K-9 from Kim McCullough and David Luck.

Dr. Joe Hashem, who is living full-time at the home on I-2, purchased from Evella and William Garrett.

Leon and Greta Weinberger of Rockville, MD, who purchased Lot D-1 from the Mannekins.

★★★★★★★★★★

Mark Your Calendar for the Fifth Annual CMA Plant-In, Fix-Up, Clean-Up Day, Saturday, May 4. Lunch will be provided, and the Day will feature Good Clean Fun. Come and work shoulder to shoulder in the sunshine (no guarantees!) with your CMA neighbors. It's good for the soul.

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News Notes...

* Some CMA members are reviewing rental contract arrangements with the intent of negotiating new contract terms with CRI. If you are in the process of reviewing your contract or signing a new contract, you may want to wait until this effort has been completed.

* Members may be temporarily inconvenienced this spring by two noises: (1) gravel-carrying trucks going to Lagoon 1 to begin the constructed wetlands project; and (2) an aerial mapping plane, taking photographs for an accurate topographical map.

* CMA sends its sympathy to the family of Charles Myers who died in December 1990. Charles and his wife Evelyn, from Silver Spring, MD, own "Whipporwill" on Lot E-2.

CORRECTIONS

There are two items that appeared in the December 1990 issue of **The Mountainside News** that need to be corrected.

One the first page, first paragraph, last line: The By-Laws require a 30% quorum for a General Meeting, not 60%.

And perhaps most importantly: Elmer Broxson's phone number is **202/333-8872.** It was listed incorrectly on page 3. PLEASE MAKE THAT CHANGE, for the sake of the poor person who has been getting Elmer's phone calls!

Mountainside Update

Water: During these winter months, there has been substantial progress in the effort to render the water system reliable. Under the general category of 'Maintenance', the pump that failed last fall is being rebuilt to serve as a back-up pump. Two water lines in the E section are being replaced to stop major leaks that were draining the system. The owners of the houses where the leaks occurred are paying for these repairs, since owners are responsible for the part of the system between the water meter and the house.

Under the category of 'Capital Improvements', CMA has engaged an engineer recommended by the state health department to study the water system and propose changes to improve its reliability. The engineer will survey and set out markers at two foot intervals to establish topographical gradations along the mountainside. These markers will be used by an aerial mapping service that will photograph the entire 410-acre CMA area. This map will provide data for upgrading the water system, and also for sewer system improvement (wetlands project) and for complementing site plans for new houses, as required by the revised DACC Guidelines. Individual homeowners may purchase copies of sections of the map showing their properties at a fee to be determined.

Sewer: The Brockson and Brand environmental engineering firm is submitting a permit application to the state for a constructed wetlands in Lagoon 1, modifying CMA's existing sewage treatment system to bring it into compliance with revised state effluent standards. Work will begin when the plans are approved and the bidding process has identified a contractor.

Barn and Shed: There have been repairs to shore up the barn, and the shed next to it is being reroofed. The lights in the barn have also been repaired.

Tennis Courts: It has been determined that the cause of the surface peeling on the tennis courts was inferior. The courts will be repainted with appropriate paint.

Pool: CMA will drill drainage holes in west side of the deck around the pool, because water is not draining properly from this area.

Gatehouse Project: Charles Barrett is in the process of designing the gatehouse which will delineate the boundaries of CMA property on Herbert Quick Drive. This project should be completed in the spring.

Next Board Meeting: Saturday, March 2, 1991, 9:00 a.m.
Bethesda Library

The Mountainside News is published quarterly by the Coolfont Mountainside Association, Box 21, Coolfont Rd., West Virginia 25411. Editor: Sarah H. Hay, 7930 Brink Rd, Gaithersburg, Md 20882 (301/926-7007). Letters, articles, and comments are welcome.